of the Brazilian Atlantic Forest has been destroyed. However, global deforestation rates are slowing.



Polluting smoke rises over Brazilian rainforest being cleared for agriculture. Brazil clears around 1.1 million hectares of rainforest a year, but deforestation rates are slowing.

“We are unable to remain silent in the face of so much injustice.”

Chico Mendes

Effects on biodiversity

Recent estimates suggest that almost half of all forest clearance is carried out by subsistence farmers, and a third by commercial interests. Urban development, logging for the best-quality lumber, mining and quarrying, and trees cut for firewood account for any remaining deforestation. In every case, the environment suffers. Biodiversity is particularly impacted, because only a small number of mammal, bird, and invertebrate species can live on